

General Notes on FEOM

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This PDF contains general notes on the FEOM project, including information about the project structure, coding conventions, and other relevant details.

I. Project Structure

This project implements HEOM using FORTRAN, and implements basic HEOM with the standard K and L cutoffs. In the notation used by FORTRAN propagation, we have

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{d}{dt}\rho_{\mathbf{n}}(t) = & -\frac{i}{\hbar}H_s^\times\rho_{\mathbf{n}}(t) - \sum_k n_k\gamma_k\rho_{\mathbf{n}}(t) - \frac{i}{\hbar}\sum_k \left(c_U(k, n_k)V^\times\rho_{\mathbf{n}_k^+}(t)\right) \\ & + \frac{i}{\hbar}\sum_k \left(c_{\text{DLEFT}}(k, n_k)V^L\rho_{\mathbf{n}_k^-}(t) + c_{\text{DRIGHT}}(k, n_k)V^R\rho_{\mathbf{n}_k^-}(t)\right), \end{aligned} \quad (1)$$

where $\rho_{\mathbf{n}}(t)$ is the full set of ADOs, $\mathbf{n}$ is the vector of ADO indices $\{n_k\}$, (with $\mathbf{n}_k^\pm$ denoting the same set of indices, but with $n_k \pm 1$). We use superoperator notation throughout, and define our coefficients $\{\gamma_k, c_U, c_D\}$ differently for each version of the HEOM used.

A. Shi/Chen scaled HEOM

For Shi/Chen scaled HEOM [1], the equations of motion are given by

$$\frac{d}{dt}\rho_{\mathbf{n}}(t) = -\frac{i}{\hbar}H_s^\times\rho_{\mathbf{n}}(t) - \sum_k n_k\gamma_k\rho_{\mathbf{n}}(t) - \frac{i}{\hbar}\sum_k \left(\sqrt{n_k+1}\mathcal{L}_{k-}\rho_{\mathbf{n}_k^+}(t) + \sqrt{n_k}\mathcal{L}_{k+}\rho_{\mathbf{n}_k^-}(t)\right), \quad (2)$$

where $\rho_{\mathbf{n}}(t)$ is the full set of ADOs, $\mathbf{n}$ is the vector of ADO indices $\{n_k\}$, (with $\mathbf{n}_k^\pm$ denoting the same set of indices, but with $n_k \pm 1$). We use superoperator notation throughout, H_s as the system Hamiltonian, the superoperators $\mathcal{L}_{k-}$ and $\mathcal{L}_{k+}$ are defined as the superoperator

$$\mathcal{L}_{k-} = \sqrt{|C_k|}V^\times, \quad \mathcal{L}_{k+} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{|C_k|}}(C_kV^L - C_k^*V^R), \quad (3)$$

where V is the system-bath coupling operator, C_k is the coupling strength for the k 'th bath mode, and the constants C_k and γ_k are obtained from the bath correlation function (BCF) as

$$C(t) = \sum_k C_k e^{-\gamma_k t}, \quad (4)$$

which results in the coefficients,

$$c_U(k, n_k) = \sqrt{n_k+1}|C_k|, \quad c_{\text{DLEFT}}(k, n_k) = -\sqrt{\frac{n_k}{|C_k|}}C_k, \quad c_{\text{DRIGHT}}(k, n_k) = \sqrt{\frac{n_k}{|C_k|}}C_k^*, \quad (5)$$

and γ_k being the decay rate of the k 'th bath mode, and K modes chosen to represent the BCF. In what follows, any sums over k are assumed to go from 1 to K , unless otherwise specified.

II. Bath conventions

In this section, we discuss the conventions used for the naming of the baths. We define the spectral density

$$J(\omega) = \frac{\pi}{2} \sum_{\alpha} \frac{c_{\alpha}^2}{m_{\alpha} \omega} [\delta(\omega - \omega_{\alpha}) + \delta(\omega + \omega_{\alpha})], \quad (6)$$

where c_{α} is the coupling strength, m_{α} is the mass, and ω_{α} is the frequency of the α 'th bath mode. It is assumed that $\omega_{\alpha} \geq 0$, such that $J(\omega) = -J(-\omega)$. With this definition, the equilibrium bath correlation function (BCF), at inverse temperature β , is given as

$$C(t) = \frac{\hbar}{2\pi} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} d\omega J(\omega) \left(\coth \left(\frac{\beta \hbar \omega}{2} \right) \cos \omega t - i \sin \omega t \right), \quad (7)$$

which is done using residues. Now to get onto specific bath distributions.

A. Debye bath

The Debye bath is defined by the spectral density

$$J(\omega) = \frac{\eta \gamma \omega}{\omega^2 + \gamma^2}, \quad (8)$$

where η is the coupling strength and γ is the cutoff frequency. The correlation function is of exponential form, parameterized by frequencies $\{\gamma_k\}$,

$$\gamma_0 = \gamma, \quad \gamma_k = \omega_{n=k} = \frac{2n\pi}{\beta \hbar}, \quad (9)$$

and prefactors $\{C_k\}$, which are given by

$$C_0 = \frac{\hbar \eta \gamma}{2} \left(\cot \frac{\beta \hbar \gamma}{2} - i \right), \quad C_{n=k} = -\frac{2\eta \gamma}{\beta} \frac{\omega_n}{\gamma^2 - \omega_n^2}, \quad \forall k > 0. \quad (10)$$

For systems with bath renormalisation (such as the Harmonic oscillator), the system Hamiltonian gains the term

$$\begin{aligned} H_{\text{ren}} &= \frac{1}{2} \sum_{\alpha} \frac{c_{\alpha}^2}{m_{\alpha} \omega_{\alpha}^2} s^2 \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \eta s^2, \end{aligned} \quad (11)$$

where s is the system operator that is coupled to the bath.

B. Dealing with Matsubara poles

The code is so far only able to use Debye baths. It can however decompose the Matsubara terms in the BCF in many different ways:

- *nbead*: N-bead approximation to the bath, replacing the Matsubara frequencies with the Ring-Polymer ones.
- *nmats*: Use K Matsubara modes, with only K modes in the pre-factor (instead of the cot, which has infinite)
- *matsubara*: Use infinite Matsubara modes, but only include K of them in propagation (this often comes with Ishizaki-Tanimura termination of the unused modes)
- *Padé*: Following Ref. [2] we can either use the N/N or $N-1/N$ Padé approximants of the hyperbolic cotangent

- *AAA*: Decompose the hyperbolic cotangent with AAA algorithm. This paper is under construction. It is a little hacky still, as the file must run a matlab script to do the decomposition (taken from the first AAA paper in Ref. [4])

Though it is hard-coded for Debye baths, these implementations are relatively modular, so it should be pretty easy to generalise for different spectral densities. The main thing to watch out for are the C_k 's, as these will contain the residues of $J(i\gamma_k)$.

III. Truncations

The truncation falls into two categories, which I refer to as call exponential term truncation and depth truncation. I have not yet implemented any depth truncations, and just set the next set of ADOs to zero. This is in line with the scaling of Shi-Chen HEOM, which ensures that the norm of ADOs decreases as The exponential term truncation is the approximation of the bath correlation function (BCF) by a finite number of exponentials. The heirarchy truncation is the removal of the dependence of the ADOs on those with a larger depth.

A. Ishizaki-Tanimura truncation

This truncation was created by Ishizaki and Tanimura in Ref.[3]. It is a Markovian approximation of the higher order Matsubara terms in the BCF;

$$e^{-\gamma_k t} \approx \frac{1}{\gamma_k} \delta_+(t), \quad \forall k > k_c, \quad (12)$$

where k_c is the cutoff in number of exponentials in the BCF¹ and $\delta_+(t)$ is a delta function defined for $t \geq 0$. The delta functions are inserted into the influence functional, allowing us to do the inner integral over the history, yielding a new term in the dynamics,

$$\Xi \rho_{\mathbf{n}}(t) = \sum_{k > k_c} \frac{1}{\gamma_k} \mathcal{L}_k - \mathcal{L}_{k+} \rho_{\mathbf{n}}(t). \quad (13)$$

For the example of a Debye bath, we can do the sum formally. Due to all of the C_k for $k > 0$ being real, we can write the superoperator as

$$\Xi_{\text{debye}} = -\frac{1}{\hbar^2} \sum_{k > k_c} \frac{1}{\gamma_k} C_k (V^\times)^2 = \frac{2\eta\gamma}{\beta\hbar^2} \sum_{n > k_c} \frac{1}{\gamma^2 - \omega_n^2} (V^\times)^2 \quad (14)$$

Then we use the fact that

$$\begin{aligned} \cot z &= \frac{1}{z} + \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \frac{2z}{z^2 - n^2\pi^2} \\ \therefore \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{\gamma^2 - \omega_n^2} &= \frac{\beta\hbar}{4\gamma} \left(\cot \frac{\beta\hbar\gamma}{2} - \frac{2}{\beta\hbar\gamma} \right), \end{aligned} \quad (15)$$

to calculate the sum, giving us

$$\Xi_{\text{debye}} = \eta \underbrace{\left[\frac{1}{2\hbar} \left(\cot \frac{\beta\hbar\gamma}{2} - \frac{2}{\beta\hbar\gamma} \right) - \frac{2\gamma}{\beta\hbar^2} \sum_{n=1}^{k_c} \frac{1}{\gamma^2 - \omega_n^2} \right]}_{\text{lowTcoef}} (V^\times)^2. \quad (16)$$

In the code, *lowTcoef* is the name of the variable used to hold the coefficient.

¹these are ordered in increasing real part, as then the approximation is more accurate for larger k

B. Fay and perturbative corrections

Fay's Low temperature correction term is similar to that of Ishizaki-Tanimura, but is derived by projecting out the non-active ADOs. Let's first give an outline of the derivation. The EOM of all of the ADOs, which live in the product space between the Liouville space of the system and the ADO index space², are

$$\frac{d}{dt}\rho(t) = \mathcal{L}\rho(t) = (\underbrace{\mathcal{L}_S \otimes I_{\text{ado}} - I_S \otimes \Gamma + \mathcal{V}}_{\mathcal{L}_0})\rho(t), \quad (17)$$

where $\mathcal{L}_S$ is the free system Liouvillian,

$$\mathcal{V} = \sum_{\text{all } \mathbf{n}} \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} (\sqrt{n_k+1} \mathcal{L}_k^- \otimes |\mathbf{n}\rangle\langle \mathbf{n}_{k+}| + \sqrt{n_k} \mathcal{L}_k^+ \otimes |\mathbf{n}\rangle\langle \mathbf{n}_{k-}|), \quad (18)$$

which couples adjacent ADOs, and

$$\Gamma = \sum_{\text{all } \mathbf{n}} \left(\sum_{k=0}^{\infty} n_k \gamma_k \right) |\mathbf{n}\rangle\langle \mathbf{n}|, \quad (19)$$

which is the diagonal decay of each ADO. To derive the correction, Fay defines the projector

$$\mathcal{P} := \sum_{\mathbf{n} \in N_M} |\mathbf{n}\rangle\langle \mathbf{n}|, \quad \mathcal{Q} := 1 - \mathcal{P} \quad (20)$$

where the set N_M is all $\mathbf{n}$ such that $\mathbf{n}_{k>M} = 0$ and M is the cutoff for the number of exponential terms to include in the BCF. In terms of 'excitations', this projector projects the ADOs into the set of ADOs with zero excitations in the exponentials beyond the cutoff M . Using Nakajima-Zwanzig theory,

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{d}{dt}\mathcal{P}\rho(t) &= \mathcal{P}\mathcal{L}\mathcal{P}\rho(t) + \int_0^t d\tau \mathcal{P}\mathcal{L}\mathcal{Q}e^{\mathcal{Q}\mathcal{L}\tau} \mathcal{Q}\mathcal{L}\mathcal{P}\rho(t-\tau) \\ &\approx \mathcal{P}\mathcal{L}\mathcal{P}\rho(t) + \mathcal{K}\rho(t), \end{aligned} \quad [\mathcal{O}(\mathcal{V}^2) \text{ perturb.} + \text{Markovian approx.}] \quad (21)$$

where

$$\mathcal{K} = \int_0^\infty d\tau \mathcal{P}\mathcal{L}\mathcal{Q}e^{\mathcal{L}_0\tau} \mathcal{Q}\mathcal{L}\mathcal{P}. \quad (22)$$

He then calculates this integral. This is done by considering the products $\mathcal{Q}\mathcal{L}\mathcal{P}$ and $\mathcal{P}\mathcal{L}\mathcal{Q}$. Inter-ADO coupling is due to $\mathcal{V}$, which couples adjacent ADOs. Since the projectors by definition do not intersect one-another in ADO space, only the states of $\mathbf{n}_{k>M} = 0, 1$ (on the boundary between projectors) will give a non-zero projection. This means that

$$\mathcal{Q}\mathcal{L}\mathcal{P} = \sum_{\mathbf{n} \in N_M} \sum_{k>M} \mathcal{L}_k^+ \otimes |\mathbf{n}_{k+}\rangle\langle \mathbf{n}|, \quad (23)$$

$[\implies n_k = 0]$

and

$$\mathcal{P}\mathcal{L}\mathcal{Q} = \sum_{\mathbf{n} \in N_M} \sum_{k>M} \mathcal{L}_k^- \otimes |\mathbf{n}\rangle\langle \mathbf{n}_{k+}|. \quad (24)$$

²i.e. the system Liouvillian $\hat{\mathcal{L}}_S$ is a linear operator and the system density matrix $|\rho_s\rangle$ is a vector of the Liouville space, the projectors between different ADOs $|\mathbf{n}\rangle\langle \mathbf{n}'|$ is a linear operator and the ADO index $\langle \mathbf{n}|$ is a vector of the ADO space, and the total Hilbert space is the product space of the two, for example the system density matrix is $|\rho_s\rangle \otimes |\mathbf{0}\rangle\langle \mathbf{0}|$.

Finally, we diagonalize the system Liouvillian with $\Lambda_s = \Pi_s^{-1} \mathcal{L}_s \Pi_s$, giving

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{K} &= \int_0^\infty dt \sum_{\mathbf{n} \in N_M} \sum_{k>M} \mathcal{L}_k^- \otimes |\mathbf{n}\rangle\langle \mathbf{n}_{k+}| \Pi_s^{-1} \exp\{(\Lambda_s \otimes I_{\text{ado}} - I_s \otimes \Gamma)t\} \Pi_s \sum_{\mathbf{n}' \in N_M} \sum_{k'>M} \mathcal{L}_{k'}^+ \otimes |\mathbf{n}'_{k'+}\rangle\langle \mathbf{n}'| \\ &= \sum_{\mathbf{n} \in N_M} |\mathbf{n}\rangle\langle \mathbf{n}| \underbrace{\sum_{k>M} \mathcal{L}_k^- \Pi_s^{-1} \frac{1}{-\Lambda_s + \gamma_k + \sum_{k'=0}^\infty n'_k \gamma'_k} \Pi_s \mathcal{L}_k^+}_{\Xi_{\mathbf{n}}}, \end{aligned} \quad (25)$$

leaving us with Tom's low temperature correction, $\Xi_{\mathbf{n}}$, which is different for each ADO. Note that the sum over k' goes to infinity, but as all $n_{k>M} = 0$, this is equivalent to just using the first M terms. This terminator is known as 'NZ2' in the code.

One could also derive a more simple correction. We start by splitting the influence functional into the 'normal part' and the Markovian part;

$$F = F_0 F_M, \quad (26)$$

where F_0 has the low-frequency exponentials that will for the HEOM heirarchy within the projector $\mathcal{P}$, and

$$F_M = \exp\left\{-\frac{1}{\hbar^2} \sum_{n>M} d_n \int_0^t d\tau y_1(\tau) \int_0^\tau d\sigma y_1(\sigma) e^{-\omega_n(\tau-\sigma)}\right\}, \quad (27)$$

where $\{d_n\}$ are the prefactors for the Matsubara terms in the correlation function³. Note that the Ishizaki-Tanimura correction was derived previously, by approximating $A_M(\omega)$, such that the integration over the spectral density resulted in a delta function (instead of an exponential), which then allowed the integration of the integral over σ , to give the time-local correction. For Fay's correction however, we need to treat the equation perturbatively. One way to do this is the insertion of the zeroth-order approximation

$$y_1(\sigma) \approx e^{-\mathcal{L}_s(\sigma-\tau)} y_1(\tau), \quad \text{approximation [1]} \quad (28)$$

where $\mathcal{L}_s$ is the free system Liouvillian, and the minus sign is due to operators propagating in the opposite direction in time relative to the density matrix. We also give the inner integral infinite history, to give

$$\begin{aligned} F_M &\approx F_M^{[1]} = \exp\left\{-\frac{1}{\hbar^2} \sum_{n>M} d_n \int_0^t d\tau y_1(\tau) \int_{-\infty}^\tau d\sigma \exp\{(\mathcal{L}_s - \omega_n)(\tau - \sigma)\} y_1(\sigma)\right\} \\ &= \exp\left\{-\frac{1}{\hbar^2} \sum_{n>M} d_n \int_0^t d\tau y_1(\tau) \Pi_s^{-1} \frac{1}{\omega_n - \Lambda_s} \Pi_s y_1(\tau)\right\}. \end{aligned} \quad (29)$$

This results in a terminator that is correct in the weak-coupling limit,⁴ but does not reproduce Fay's terminator. It instead applies the same terminator $\Xi_{\mathbf{n}=0}$ on all ADOs. This method is known as 'PT2' in the code. To reproduce Fay's terminator along the same lines as above, we would want apply a different approximation for each ADO. For the influence functional part of the $\mathbf{n}$ 'th ADO, we apply

$$y_1(\sigma) \approx e^{-\left(\mathcal{L}_s - \sum_{k=0}^\infty n_k \gamma_k\right)(\sigma-\tau)} y_1(\tau), \quad \text{approximation [2]} \quad (30)$$

where we have replaced $\mathcal{L}_s \leftarrow \langle \mathbf{n} | \mathcal{L}_0 | \mathbf{n} \rangle$. If one then follows through with the above derivation, Fay's terminator is regenerated. The Fay approximation is therefore equivalent to calculating the influence functional for the $n > M$ modes using an infinite system history generated from

³of course these frequencies needn't be Matsubara ones (see the next section)

⁴see appendix of Tom's paper

uncoupled dynamics of the ADOs.

We needn't give the ADOs infinite history though. If we do not, for the example of approximation [1], we have

$$F_M \approx F_M^{[1]\text{non-Markov}} = \exp \left\{ -\frac{1}{\hbar^2} \sum_{n>M} d_n \int_0^t d\tau y_1(\tau) \Pi_s^{-1} \frac{1 - e^{(\Lambda_s - \omega_n)t}}{\omega_n - \Lambda_s} \Pi_s y_1(\tau) \right\}, \quad (31)$$

which adds a driving term into the low-temperature correction,

$$\Xi^{[1]\text{non-Markov}}(t) = \Xi_{\mathbf{0}} + \frac{i}{\hbar} s^\times \Pi_s^{-1} \sum_{n>M} \frac{d_n e^{(\Lambda_s - \omega_n)t}}{\omega_n - \Lambda_s} \Pi_s s^\times, \quad (32)$$

where we have replaced $y(t)$ with the super-operator $s^\times$, which is by definition evaluated at time t . The Fay-type terminator, $\Xi^{[2]\text{non-Markov}}(t)$, looks almost exactly the same, with the replacement $\Lambda_s \leftarrow \Lambda_s - \sum_k n_k \gamma_k$, and $\mathbf{0} \leftarrow \mathbf{n}$. For both of these corrections, the terminator has no effect at $t = 0$, which I think is interesting. I have not implemented this one as it requires a time-dependent Liouvillian, which would make propagation difficult.

C. Important points on implementation of corrections

Let's say that we have approximated the BCF by some K_{tot} -mode correlation function $C_{K_{\text{tot}}}(t)$. The correction terms are then added on by decomposing the exact correlation function $C^{[\text{exact}]}(t)$ as

$$C^{[\text{exact}]}(t) \equiv C_\infty^{[\text{Mats}]}(t) = C_{K_{\text{tot}}}(t) + \underbrace{\left[C_N^{[\text{Mats}]}(t) - C_{K_{\text{tot}}}(t) \right]}_{\delta C(t)} + \underbrace{\left[C_\infty^{[\text{Mats}]}(t) - C_N^{[\text{Mats}]}(t) \right]}_{C^{[\text{Mark}]}(t)} \quad (33)$$

We then do the Fay/perturbative correction on $\delta C(t)$. The value of N used is large, but finite, such that the manual sums can be done quickly in the calculation of the terminators. The final term $C^{[\text{Mark}]}(t)$ is treated Markovianally, adding on an Ishizaki-Tanimura term. The value of N is chosen such that the Markovian approximation of this term is appropriate.

IV. Unit Conventions

Throughout the code, we set $\hbar = 1$. I have not benchmarked otherwise, so need to remove $\hbar$ in general. As $[\hbar] = [\text{E}][t]$, we just have to make sure that the energy and time are inputted in consistent units for the correct outputs. Commonly used units are cm^{-1} and fs for the energy and time units respectively. To yield a correlation function as a function of time in fs we need to convert the energies to fs^{-1} .

$$E_{\text{fs}^{-1}} = 2\pi c_{\text{cm fs}^{-1}} E_{\text{cm}^{-1}}. \quad (34)$$

References

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